

David Hall

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Research Interests

Health economics; public economics; substance use and drug markets; applied econometrics.

Education

University of Oregon — Ph.D. in Economics Expected Summer 2027

Advisor: Benjamin Hansen. Fields: Health Economics, Public Economics, and Applied Econometrics.

California Lutheran University — M.S. in Quantitative Economics May 2022

Thesis: *Forecast of Employment Inflows and Outflows*.

California Lutheran University — B.A. in Economics and Mathematics May 2021

Economics thesis: *The Effect of Different-Race Policing on Excessive Use-of-Force Cases*. Mathematics thesis: *An Optimization of Political Lying*.

Job Market Paper

Pour Decisions: Alcohol Privatization and Birth Outcomes Job Market Paper

Washington's Initiative 1183 privatized spirits retailing in June 2012 and sharply expanded entry by grocery and big-box stores. NielsenIQ Homescan data indicate that household spirits purchases increased by 35 percent, while total ethanol-equivalent purchasing rose a more suggestive 9.2 percent as households substituted across beverage categories. Using restricted-use vital statistics and repeated-cross-section synthetic difference-in-differences, I estimate a 10.28-gram decline in average birth weight and a 0.357-percentage-point increase in small-for-gestational-age births, although Washington is not unusually extreme in complete placebo-state refits. A complementary within-Washington design shows a strong first stage for local spirits access but mixed birth-health effects. The findings show that large aggregate demand responses need not produce equally large population-specific harms when the behavioral response is not concentrated in the population relevant to that harm.

Working Papers

Did Decriminalization Increase Overdoses? (with Benjamin Hansen and Kyutaro Matsuzawa)

NBER Working Paper No. 35427. Uses synthetic-control methods to study Oregon's Measure 110 and Washington's *Blake* decision, separating policy effects from the contemporaneous spread of fentanyl and assessing changes in drug arrests and overdose mortality.

Does Substance Use Treatment Still Reduce Mortality?

Extends earlier estimates of the relationship between treatment-center availability and overdose mortality through 2022. The protective relationship weakens as the opioid epidemic shifts toward fentanyl and polysubstance use.

The Deterrence Impacts of Fentanyl Supply Laws

Studies California Assembly Bill 701. State-level estimates show little evidence of reduced aggregate drug activity, while incident-level evidence suggests substitution away from quantities above the law's sentencing thresholds.

Work in Progress

- *Treatment Center Ownership and Market Learning*
- *Public Provision and Crowding Out: The Case of Naloxone*
- *Did Retail Availability of Naloxone Affect Elasticity?*
- *A Regime-Switching Model of the Opioid Epidemic*

Research Experience and Fellowships

Research Assistant, University of Oregon Summer 2025–Present

Benjamin Hansen (PI); research supported by Arnold Ventures.

Predoctoral Fellow, Behavioral Science Training: Drug Abuse (NIH T32) Summer 2023–Summer 2025

New York University.

Overton Fellow in Economics, California Lutheran University Summer 2020

Project: *The Effect of Police Agency Unionization on Use-of-Force Cases*.

Teaching Experience

Lead Instructor, Introduction to Econometrics (EC 320), University of Oregon Fall 2025
Designed and taught undergraduate econometrics, including statistical inference, causal inference, and applied analysis in R.

Teaching Assistant, University of Oregon Fall 2022–Spring 2023
Courses: Introduction to Economic Analysis (EC 101), Introduction to Economic Analysis: Microeconomics (EC 201), and Introduction to Economic Analysis: Macroeconomics (EC 202).

Conference Presentations

Pour Decisions: Alcohol Privatization and Birth Outcomes

APPAM Fall Research Conference (November 2026, scheduled); ASHEcon Annual Conference (June 2026).

Did Decriminalization Increase Overdoses?

Western Economic Association International Annual Conference (July 2026); APPAM Fall Research Conference (November 2025); ASHEcon Annual Conference (June 2024).

Does Substance Use Treatment Still Reduce Mortality?

Western Social Science Association Annual Conference (April 2025).

Professional and Public Service

Council Member, Behavioral Health Resource Network Oversight and Accountability Council
2026–Present

Oregon Health Authority.

President, Economics GE Guild, University of Oregon 2024–2025

Ad hoc referee

Journal of Health Economics; *Studies in Nonlinear Dynamics and Econometrics*; *International Review of Law and Economics*; *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*; *Drug and Alcohol Review*.

Undergraduate Thesis Mentor, University of Oregon 2026

Student: Jaya Baker.

Mentor, Women in Economics, University of Oregon

Guest Lecturer, Student Academy to Inspire Learning, University of Oregon 2024, 2026

Council Member, Emmaus Fund, Emmaus Lutheran Church, Eugene, Oregon

Awards and Honors

M. Gregg Smith Fellowship 2026

University of Oregon First-Year Econometrics Award 2023

IIF Certificate of Forecasting 2021

University Honors Program with Distinction 2021

Economics Departmental Distinction 2020

Overton Summer Research Fellowship 2020

Presidential Scholar 2017–2021

Dean's List 2017–2021

Technical Skills

Advanced: R. **Intermediate:** Python, Stata, EViews, MySQL, and Power BI.

Additional Experience

Pricing Analyst, AmeriHome Mortgage Company, LLC January 2021–May 2022
Thousand Oaks, California.

Professional Memberships

American Economic Association; American Society for Health Economics.